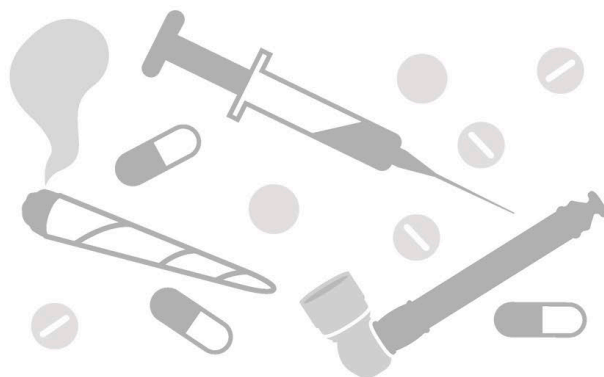


Types of drugs

There are many different types of drugs, as well as many street names associated with each of them. All drug use carries risks, and teens should be aware of the effects and risks before making a decision about whether or not to take drugs.

Categories

Some drugs have hallucinogenic effects, which means that they cause people to see things that are not real, while others affect a person's mood and behavior. Other types of drugs have a depressant effect, which means they slow down the body and its functions. Stimulants are drugs that have the opposite effect—they speed up the body, giving the user more energy and alertness. Certain drugs combine some or all of these characteristics.



SEE ALSO

◀ 18–19 Thinking independently

◀ 94–95 Anxiety and depression

◀ 166–167 Drug use and abuse

Peer pressure

192–193 ▶

Drug	Form	Use	Effects	Risks
Anabolic steroids	Liquid, tablet	Swallowed	The effects of this stimulant include increased muscle mass, and the ability to complete more strenuous exercise sessions and recover more quickly.	Risks include acne; hair loss; interrupted physical development; high blood pressure; risk of heart attack, stroke, liver failure; menstrual problems; mood swings; paranoia; and violent behavior.
Cannabis	Dried herbs or soft brown lumps	Drunk, eaten, smoked	Cannabis can act as a depressant and stimulant, as well as a hallucinogen. It can cause relaxation, giggliness, and talkativeness, and affects a person's sense of time.	Users may experience anxiety, paranoia, poor concentration, and mental health problems.
Cocaine/Crack	White powder (cocaine), lumps or "rocks" (crack)	Snorted up the nose, injected, smoked	This highly addictive stimulant leads users to feel alert, confident, and often aggressive.	Risks include breathing problems, chest pains, heart failure, mental health problems, overdose, seizures, and infections as a result of injecting.
Crystal meth	Crystals, pills, powder	Injected, smoked, snorted, swallowed	Crystal meth is very addictive. This stimulant induces feelings of elation, and alertness.	Using crystal meth can lead to infections as a result of injecting. Brain damage is possible. People can overdose, leading to organ damage, unconsciousness, or death.
Heroin	Brownish powder, white powder	Injected, smoked	This highly addictive depressant can cause users to experience feelings of well-being and relaxation.	Users are at risk of dizziness, vomiting, infections as a result of injecting, overdose, coma, or death.